

SOP — Modified Bass Technique

Needs review: Clinician notes need review before use

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Purpose

Teach patients to clean the sulcus area systematically with zero pressure, using the Modified Bass technique.

Scope

- **Applies to:** iTOP-trained clinicians instructing adult patients
- **Does not apply to:** children (chewing surfaces are handled differently)

Non-negotiable rules

- ☐ Bristles must enter the sulcus. Surface brushing is not sufficient.
- ☐ Zero pressure once in the sulcus. Movement does the work, not force.
- ☐ Systematic zone coverage. No jumping between zones.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Position the brush half on the gums and half on the teeth, bristles directed toward the sulcus. *[Source: iTOP Guidelines 2024, §3]*
2. Once in the sulcus, release all pressure. *[§3]*
3. Begin small circular movements, continuing along the jaw in overlapping strokes. *[§3]*
4. Stay in the border between soft and hard tissue, bristles always in the sulcus. *[§3]*
5. Clean all surfaces systematically. No surface left untouched. *[§3]*
6. Leave chewing surfaces until the end. *[§3]*

Products: CS 5460 ultra soft, CS smart

Assessment criteria

- **Pass:** bristles visibly placed at the gingival margin; no blanching of the gingiva; zones followed in order
- **Fail:** visible pressure, bristles on the tooth surface only, or zones skipped

Clinician notes

CLINICIAN REVIEW REQUIRED

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Sources: iTOP Clinical Protocols · SOP Templates · iTOP Guidelines 2024 (Drive)

Saved: not saved

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